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Woodley's Jewelers

User Experience Report

Document purpose: Explain the UX rationale behind the Woodley's Jewelers web application for stakeholders, designers, and developers.

Date: July 9, 2026

Executive Summary

Woodley's Jewelers is designed as a **luxury jewelry showroom experience on the web**, not a generic e-commerce template. The UX balances three goals:

1. **Inspire trust and craftsmanship** through editorial layout, warm typography, and appointment-first cues.
2. **Support real shopping workflows** — browse collections, view product detail, add to cart, and check out.
3. **Give staff a focused admin workspace** to manage inventory, orders, and storefront content without clutter.

The app intentionally separates **storefront** (public) and **dashboard** (admin), uses **URL-driven state** where filters matter, and favors **reversible actions** (deactivate) over destructive ones (delete) unless the user explicitly confirms.

Product Context

Who Uses the App

Audience	Primary Goals
Shoppers	Discover jewelry, explore categories, view details, purchase or book a visit
Members	Manage account, orders, and profile
Staff / Admins	Manage products, orders, featured items, and storefront inventory

What Kind of Business This Is

Woodley's is a **high-touch retail jeweler**. The UX reflects that:

- Phone number and **"Book Visit"** are prominent in the header.
 - Product pages emphasize imagery, craftsmanship, and category context.
 - Admin tools prioritize **inventory control** and **merchandising** (featured products, collections) over bulk operations.
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Core UX Principles

1. Editorial Luxury, Not Marketplace Clutter

Serif headlines, uppercase eyebrows, champagne/ivory surfaces, and full-bleed heroes create a showroom feel. Product grids are curated, not dense warehouse listings.

2. Appointment-First Retail

The site supports online shopping, but the experience nudges toward in-store relationships: visit CTAs, service categories (repairs, appraisals, sizing), and brand storytelling on the homepage.

3. Clear Separation of Contexts

Shoppers stay in the storefront shell (header, footer, brand navigation). Admins enter a dedicated dashboard with its own navigation and no storefront chrome — reducing confusion and accidental public exposure of admin UI.

4. Reversible Before Permanent

Products are **deactivated** rather than deleted by default. Deactivation hides items from the storefront while preserving data. Permanent delete is only available for deactivated products and requires typing **DELETE**.

5. State You Can Share and Return To

Product filters, categories, search, and sort use URL parameters so staff can bookmark views (e.g. Services → Appraisals, sorted by price) and use browser back/forward without losing context.

6. Soft Overlays, Not Blocking Darkness

Dialogs and drawers use a **light blur backdrop** so users retain spatial context of the page behind them — appropriate for a refined, non-aggressive interface.

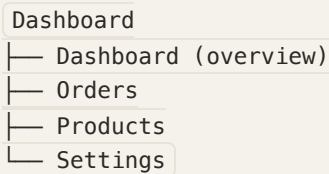
Information Architecture

Storefront Structure

```
graph TD
    Home[Home]
    Home --- Shop[Shop / Collections (by category)]
    Home --- Product[Product detail pages]
    Home --- Cart[Cart → Checkout]
    Home --- Account[Account (member self-service)]
    Home --- Content[Content (About, Contact, policies)]
    Shop --- Engagement[Engagement & Wedding]
    Shop --- Diamonds[Diamonds]
    Shop --- Custom[Custom Jewelry]
    Shop --- Fine[Fine Jewelry]
    Shop --- Watches[Watches]
    Shop --- Services[Services]
```

Rationale: Navigation mirrors how customers think about jewelry — by occasion, type, and service — not by internal SKUs or database structure.

Admin Structure



```
graph TD; Dashboard[Dashboard] --- DashboardOverview[Dashboard (overview)]; Dashboard --- Orders[Orders]; Dashboard --- Products[Products]; Dashboard --- Settings[Settings];
```

Dashboard

- Dashboard (overview)
- Orders
- Products
- Settings

Rationale: Admin nav stays shallow. Complex product organization lives **inside** the Products page, not in the global sidebar — keeping the main menu scannable.

Access Control

- Unauthenticated users are redirected to sign in.
- Non-admin users are redirected to their account area.
- Dashboard routes are excluded from search indexing.

Rationale: Admin is a private workspace; members and admins never compete for the same navigation model.

Storefront Experience

Homepage Funnel

The homepage follows an intentional editorial sequence:

1. **Hero** — rotating highlights (engagement, watches, custom work) with pause/play and keyboard support.
2. **Brand story** — why Woodley's.
3. **Showroom highlights** — featured products.
4. **New releases** — freshness and discovery.
5. **Featured categories** — entry points into the catalog.

Rationale: Lead with emotion and craftsmanship, then merchandise, then breadth — matching how customers shop in a showroom.

Collection and Shop Pages

- Full-bleed editorial heroes with breadcrumbs, eyebrow labels, and serif titles.
- Category pages feel like **magazine sections**, not filter-heavy grids.

- Shop-all combines native catalog with extended browsing where needed.

Rationale: Jewelry is visual and categorical; the layout supports browsing and inspiration before comparison.

Product Detail Page (PDP)

Element	UX Decision
Layout	Gallery left; purchase panel sticky on desktop
Hierarchy	Title → price → stock → quantity → add to cart
Feedback	Brief "added" confirmation after add-to-cart
Discovery	Similar products below the fold
Context	Breadcrumbs back to shop and category

Rationale: On PDP, the decision moment is visual and emotional; sticky purchase controls reduce scroll friction on desktop without crowding the imagery.

Cart and Checkout

Cart drawer (primary pattern)

- Opens from the header when items exist.
- Wide layout with suggestions ("We think you would like") beside the bag on larger screens.
- Checkout can start inside the drawer.

Full cart page

- Fallback for users who prefer a dedicated page or arrive via direct link.

Checkout

- Handles local catalog and Shopify flows.
- Clearly blocks **mixed carts** with guidance instead of failing silently.

Rationale: Drawer keeps shoppers in context; full page supports deep review; explicit mixed-cart messaging prevents checkout frustration.

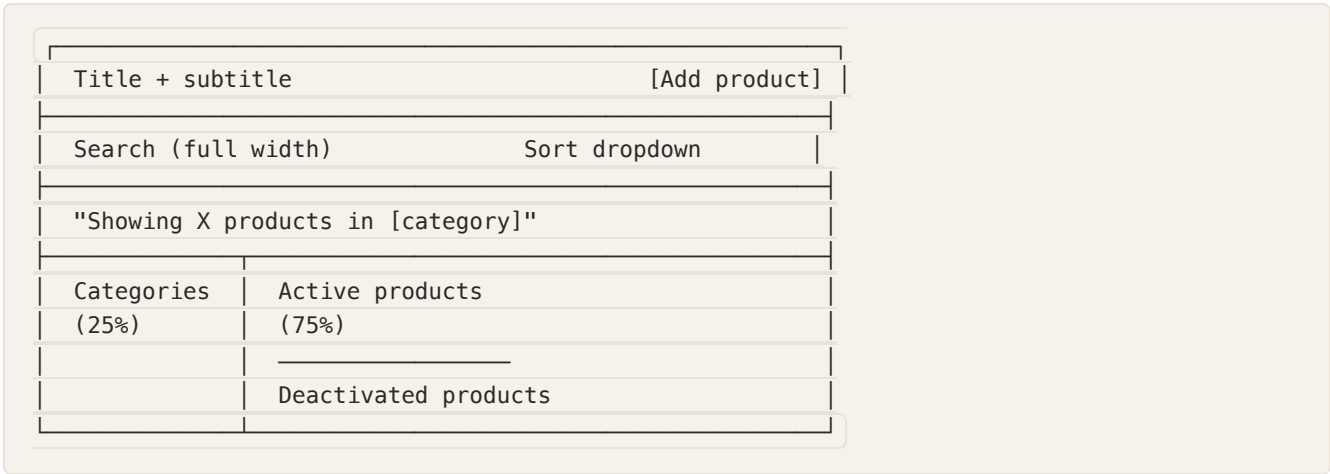
Admin Dashboard Experience

Shell and Navigation

- **Icon sidebar** on smaller screens; labels appear on large screens.
- **Solid sidebar background** for clear separation from content.
- **Active state** uses warm amber highlighting consistent with brand CTAs.
- Header shows brand, personalized welcome, and logout.

Rationale: Admins need fast wayfinding without sacrificing content space on tablets.

Products Page — Layout Decisions



Why Title and Search Are Full Width

Search and page context apply to **all** products. Keeping them above the split avoids implying search only affects one column.

Why Categories Live Inside the Page, Not the Main Sidebar

The global sidebar is for **app-level** navigation (Orders, Products, Settings). Category/subcategory browsing is **task-specific** to product management. Nesting it in the Products page:

- Keeps the main nav clean.
- Mirrors how staff think: "I'm on Products → now I'm browsing Services → Appraisals."
- Allows a dedicated category panel with counts and expandable subcategories.

Why the Split Is 25% / 75%

The category tree needs enough width for labels and counts without dominating the screen. The product list needs room for thumbnails, metadata, and action buttons.

Why Active and Deactivated Are Separate Sections

Staff need different mental models:

- **Active** = live on the storefront; supports feature, deactivate, edit.
- **Deactivated** = hidden but recoverable; supports activate, edit, delete.

Splitting them prevents accidental actions on the wrong inventory state.

Filtering and Sorting

Control	Location	Behavior
Category / subcategory	Left panel	URL: <code>?section=services&collection=appraisals</code>
Search	Top bar	Filters by name or handle
Sort	Top bar	A-Z, Z-A, price, featured, recently added/updated

Rationale: Category navigation replaced a redundant "filter by collection" dropdown. One control per job reduces duplicate paths to the same outcome.

Product Row Actions

Product State	Actions	Rationale
Active	Feature, Deactivate, Edit	Featured items surface on homepage; deactivate is reversible
Deactivated	Activate (primary), Edit, Delete	Activate is the most likely next step; delete is destructive

Activate as Primary Button

Activate uses the same amber primary style as "Add product" because it is the **main positive action** for deactivated inventory.

No Feature on Deactivated Products

Featured products must be active on the storefront. Hiding Feature on deactivated rows prevents invalid states and confusion.

Delete with Type-to-Confirm

Delete opens a dialog requiring the user to type **DELETE**. The confirm button stays disabled until the exact word is entered.

Rationale: Permanent deletion is irreversible; type-to-confirm is a proven pattern for high-stakes admin actions.

Visual Design System

Color and Mood

Role	Character
Background	Warm ivory (#faf8f4)
Text	Deep brown-gray
Accent	Warm gold for CTAs and highlights
Destructive	Red outline/text, same button shape as secondary actions

Rationale: Warm neutrals and gold align with jewelry retail — precious, calm, trustworthy — not cold tech-blue SaaS.

Typography

- **Playfair Display** — headings and editorial moments.
- **Inter** — UI, forms, and body text.

Rationale: Serif + sans pairing is common in luxury retail: character for storytelling, clarity for tasks.

Buttons

Type	Use
Primary (amber)	Add product, Activate, key CTAs
Ghost / outline	Edit, Deactivate, secondary actions
Destructive outline (red)	Delete — same shape as ghost, different color

Rationale: Shape consistency reduces visual noise; color carries meaning.

Decorative Language

Subtle fabric texture, band highlights, and image scrimms reinforce craftsmanship without distracting from product photography.

Interaction Patterns

Loading

- **Skeleton layouts** on catalog pages (layout stays stable).
- **Text states** in dashboard ("Loading products...").
- **Route transition bar** — thin amber progress under the header on navigation.

Rationale: Skeletons and progress bars feel faster than blank screens or spinners alone.

Empty States

Every major view includes guidance:

- Empty cart → "Browse catalog"
- No active products in filter → "Add your first product"
- No deactivated products → clear empty message

Rationale: Empty states are onboarding moments, not dead ends.

Feedback

- Success/error banners in admin with appropriate ARIA roles.
 - Inline form validation in checkout.
 - Brief add-to-cart confirmation on PDP.
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Accessibility

Pattern	Implementation
Landmarks	<code>main</code> , <code>nav</code> , dialog roles
Focus management	Focus moves to main on route change; focus trap in modals
Screen reader announcements	Route title announced on navigation
Keyboard	Hero carousel, mobile menu Escape, accordion controls
Reduced motion	Animations respect <code>prefers-reduced-motion</code>
Labels	Product tiles include accessible price in aria-label

Focus styling note: Default focus rings are replaced with gold underline, border accent, and background shifts — chosen to match the visual language while still meeting contrast and visibility goals.

Responsive Behavior

Breakpoint Behavior	Rationale
Header	Full nav desktop; hamburger + full-screen menu mobile
Dashboard sidebar	Icons only on small screens; labels on large
Products page	Category panel stacks above list on mobile; side-by-side on desktop
PDP	Single column mobile; sticky purchase panel desktop
Cart drawer	Horizontal scroll suggestions on mobile; column layout desktop

Touch targets (e.g. 44×44px hamburger) support mobile showroom use — customers browsing on phones in-store or at home.

Performance as UX

Choice	User Benefit
ISR / caching (60s)	Fast page loads; catalog stays reasonably fresh
Prefetch on product hover	Snappier navigation to PDP
Lazy-loaded charts	Dashboard home loads without blocking
Cart suggestions load on drawer open	Faster initial page load
Client-side filter/sort in admin	Instant response after products load
Font display: swap	Text visible during font load

Rationale: Performance choices are framed around **perceived speed** and **stable layouts**, not raw metrics alone.

Key UX Decisions — Quick Reference

Decision	What We Did	Why
Separate storefront and dashboard	Two shells, two nav models	Clear roles, less confusion
Categories inside Products page	25/75 split below search	Task-specific browsing without cluttering global nav
URL-based filters	section, collection, q, sort in URL	Shareable, refresh-safe views
Sort replaces collection filter	Single sort dropdown	Sidebar already handles category filtering
Deactivate vs delete	Deactivate default; delete only when deactivated	Reversible mistakes; delete is explicit
Type DELETE to confirm	Modal with typed confirmation	Prevents accidental data loss
Activate = primary button	Amber CTA style	Highlights the main recovery action
Delete = red outline button	Same shape as Edit, red styling	Consistent layout, clear danger
No Feature on deactivated	Hidden on inactive rows	Prevents invalid featured state
Faint blur modals	Light backdrop, not dark overlay	Premium feel; context preserved
Appointment CTAs in header	Book Visit, phone visible	Matches high-touch retail model

Stakeholder Talking Points

For Business Owners

"We designed the site like a showroom, not a warehouse. Shopping feels editorial; admin tools are simple and safe — staff can hide products without deleting them, and deletion requires explicit confirmation."

For Designers

"One visual language across storefront and admin: warm ivory, gold accents, serif headlines. Admin uses the same button hierarchy — primary for constructive actions, outline for secondary, red outline for destructive."

For Developers

"State lives in the URL where it matters. Layout splits are intentional: full-width discovery controls, then task-specific columns. Empty, loading, and error states are first-class."

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